

CHARLOTTE MASON HOMESCHOOL PLANNER

Nature Study, Living Books & Habits

Short Lessons | Narration | Nature Journals

Composer Study | Art | Handicrafts

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Charlotte Mason Homeschool Planner

Nature Study, Living Books & Habits

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Inspired by the educational philosophy of Charlotte Mason.

CHARLOTTE MASON PHILOSOPHY OVERVIEW

Charlotte Mason (1842-1923) believed children are born persons, not blank slates. Education is the science of relations - connecting children to as many living ideas and experiences as possible.

KEY PRINCIPLES:

1. **SHORT LESSONS:** 10-20 minutes per subject (young children).
Full attention for a short time beats distracted half-hours.
2. **LIVING BOOKS:** Real literature, not dry textbooks.
Books written by authors passionate about their subject.
3. **NARRATION:** The child tells back what they learned in their own words.
This replaces worksheets and tests for retention.
4. **NATURE STUDY:** Weekly outdoor time observing God's creation.
Keep a nature journal with sketches and observations.
5. **HABIT TRAINING:** One habit at a time, practiced for 4-6 weeks.
Character formation is as important as academics.
6. **THE FEAST:** Spread a wide table of subjects - don't narrow too early.
Include: math, reading, nature, art, music, poetry, handicrafts, history, geography, languages, and Scripture.
7. **ATMOSPHERE:** The home environment IS the curriculum.
Children absorb what surrounds them.

TERM 1 PLANNING

Term 1 Dates: _____ to _____

Weeks in term: _____

Subject	Book/Resource	Pages/Goals
Bible/Scripture	_____	_____
Mathematics	_____	_____
Language Arts (Reading/Writing)	_____	_____
History (Living Books)	_____	_____
Science/Nature Study	_____	_____
Geography	_____	_____
Foreign Language	_____	_____
Composer Study	_____	_____
Artist/Picture Study	_____	_____
Poetry	_____	_____
Handicraft	_____	_____
Physical Education	_____	_____

Habit to focus on this term: _____

Nature study focus: _____

Composer this term: _____ **Artist:** _____

TERM 2 PLANNING

Term 2 Dates: _____ to _____

Weeks in term: _____

Subject	Book/Resource	Pages/Goals
Bible/Scripture	_____	_____
Mathematics	_____	_____
Language Arts (Reading/Writing)	_____	_____
History (Living Books)	_____	_____
Science/Nature Study	_____	_____
Geography	_____	_____
Foreign Language	_____	_____
Composer Study	_____	_____
Artist/Picture Study	_____	_____
Poetry	_____	_____
Handicraft	_____	_____
Physical Education	_____	_____

Habit to focus on this term: _____

Nature study focus: _____

Composer this term: _____ **Artist:** _____

TERM 3 PLANNING

Term 3 Dates: _____ to _____

Weeks in term: _____

Subject	Book/Resource	Pages/Goals
Bible/Scripture	_____	_____
Mathematics	_____	_____
Language Arts (Reading/Writing)	_____	_____
History (Living Books)	_____	_____
Science/Nature Study	_____	_____
Geography	_____	_____
Foreign Language	_____	_____
Composer Study	_____	_____
Artist/Picture Study	_____	_____
Poetry	_____	_____
Handicraft	_____	_____
Physical Education	_____	_____

Habit to focus on this term: _____

Nature study focus: _____

Composer this term: _____ **Artist:** _____

DAILY SCHEDULE TEMPLATE (SHORT LESSONS)

Charlotte Mason recommended SHORT, focused lessons. Adjust times to your family.

Time	Subject	Duration
8:00 - 8:15	Morning Time (Bible, hymn, prayer)	15 min
8:15 - 8:30	Mathematics	15 min
8:30 - 8:45	Handwriting / Copywork	15 min
8:45 - 9:00	BREAK (free play, snack)	15 min
9:00 - 9:20	Reading Lesson / Literature	20 min
9:20 - 9:40	History (living book + narration)	20 min
9:40 - 9:55	BREAK (outdoor play)	15 min
9:55 - 10:10	Science / Nature Study reading	15 min
10:10 - 10:25	Geography / Map Work	15 min
10:25 - 10:40	Foreign Language	15 min
10:40 - 11:00	BREAK	20 min
11:00 - 11:15	Art / Picture Study OR Composer Study	15 min
11:15 - 11:30	Poetry / Shakespeare	15 min
11:30 - 12:00	Handicraft OR Nature Walk	30 min
12:00	DONE! Free afternoon for play and exploration.	

Notes: Total formal instruction ~3 hours. Afternoons are FREE.

Adjust lesson lengths by age: 6-9yrs=10-15min, 10-12=15-20min, 13+=20-30min

NATURE STUDY JOURNAL - Entry 1

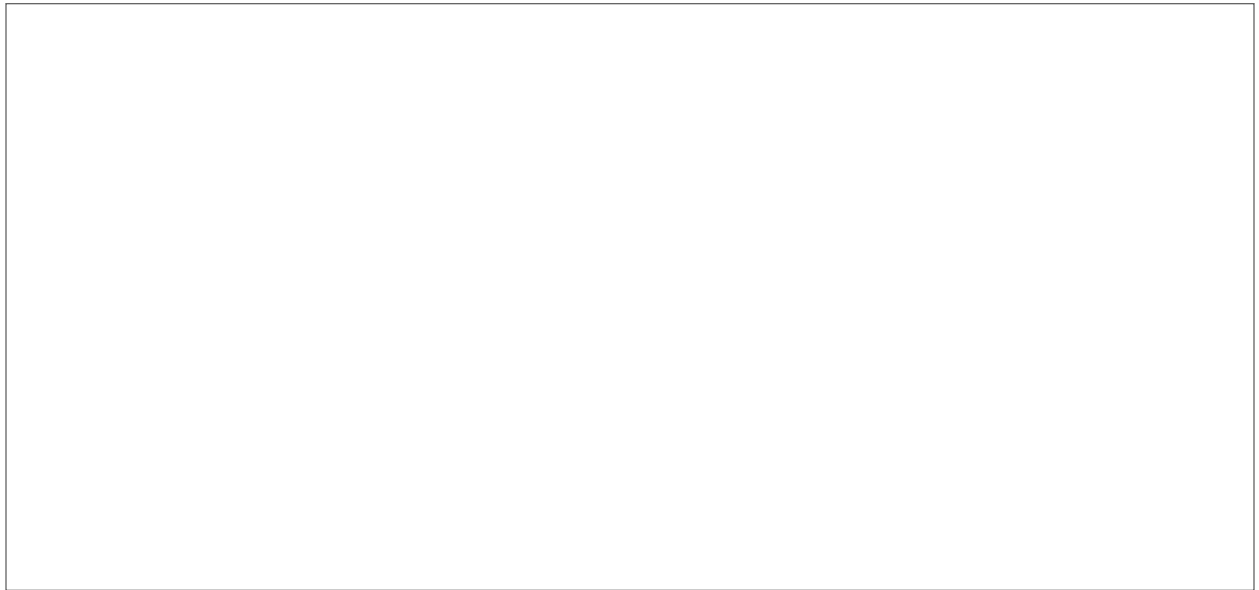
Date: _____ Location: _____

Weather: _____ Temperature: _____ Season: _____

Time spent outdoors: _____ Companions: _____

WHAT I OBSERVED TODAY:

SKETCH AREA (draw what you observed):



Species/Object identified: _____

Questions I want to research: _____

Connection to previous observations: _____

NATURE STUDY JOURNAL - Entry 2

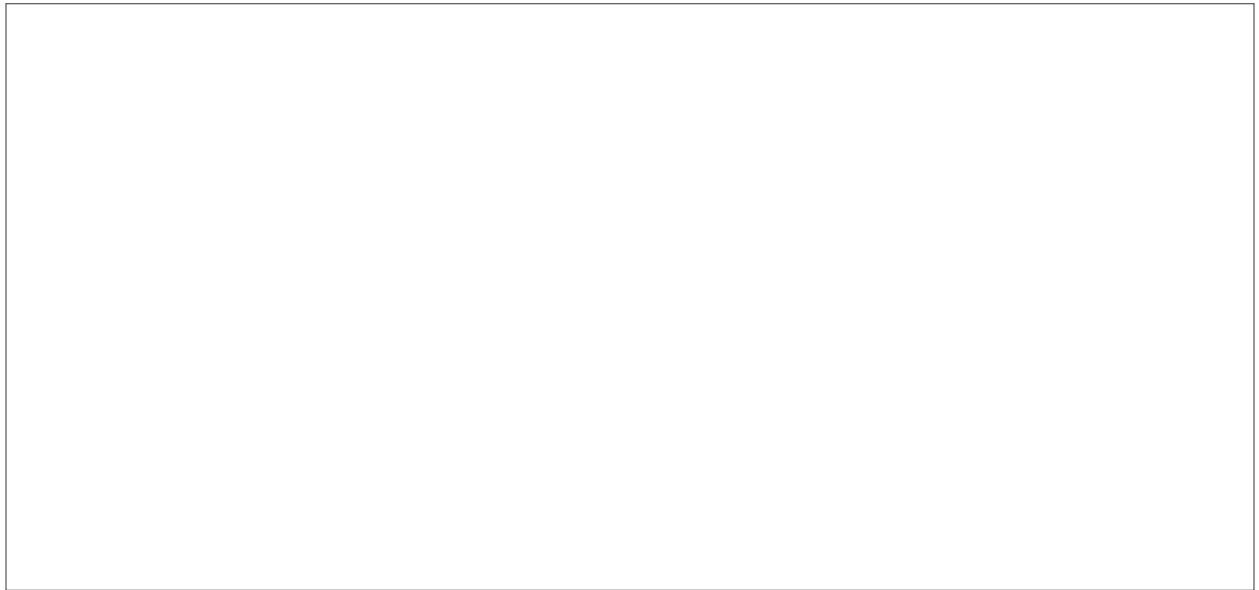
Date: _____ Location: _____

Weather: _____ Temperature: _____ Season: _____

Time spent outdoors: _____ Companions: _____

WHAT I OBSERVED TODAY:

SKETCH AREA (draw what you observed):



Species/Object identified: _____

Questions I want to research: _____

Connection to previous observations: _____

NATURE STUDY JOURNAL - Entry 3

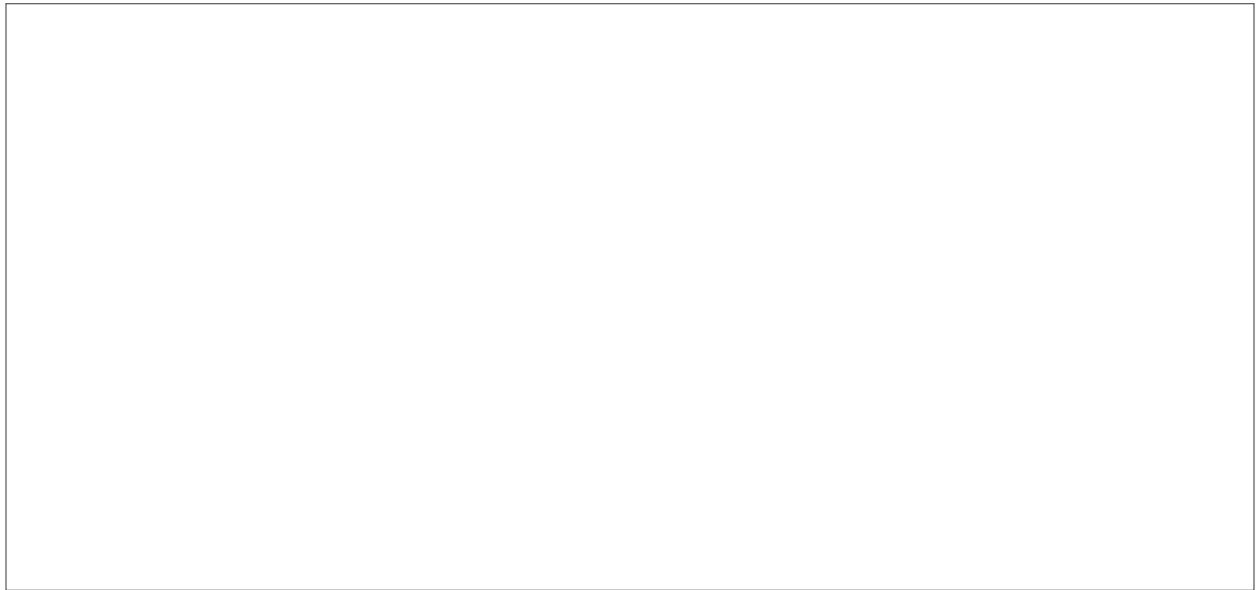
Date: _____ Location: _____

Weather: _____ Temperature: _____ Season: _____

Time spent outdoors: _____ Companions: _____

WHAT I OBSERVED TODAY:

SKETCH AREA (draw what you observed):



Species/Object identified: _____

Questions I want to research: _____

Connection to previous observations: _____

NATURE STUDY JOURNAL - Entry 4

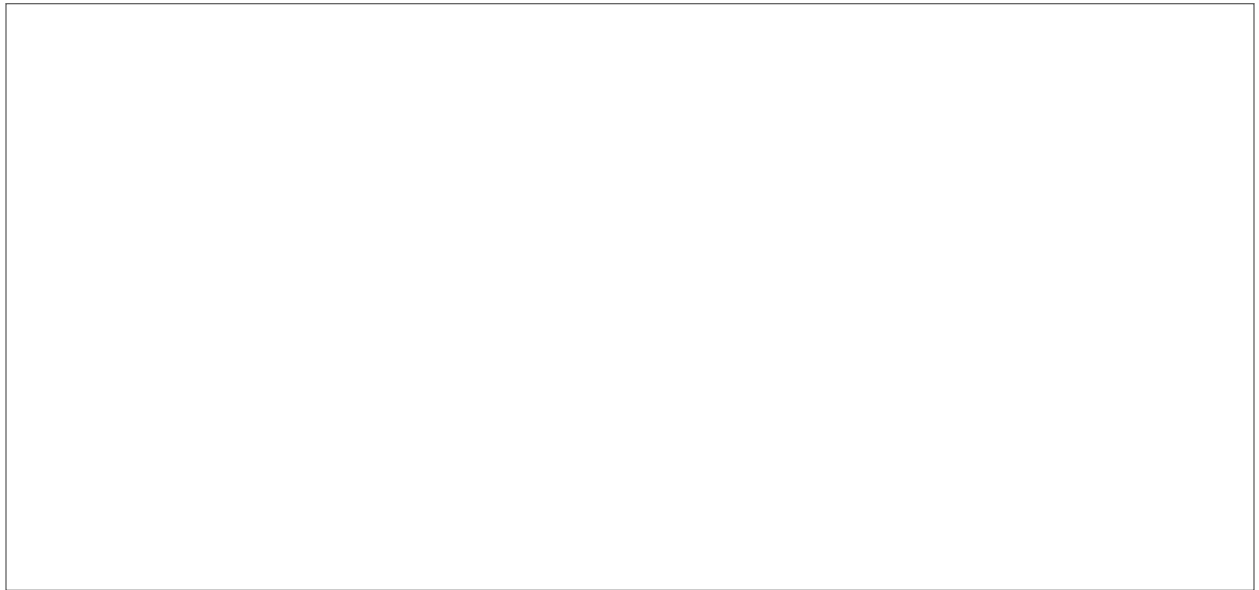
Date: _____ Location: _____

Weather: _____ Temperature: _____ Season: _____

Time spent outdoors: _____ Companions: _____

WHAT I OBSERVED TODAY:

SKETCH AREA (draw what you observed):



Species/Object identified: _____

Questions I want to research: _____

Connection to previous observations: _____

NATURE STUDY JOURNAL - Entry 5

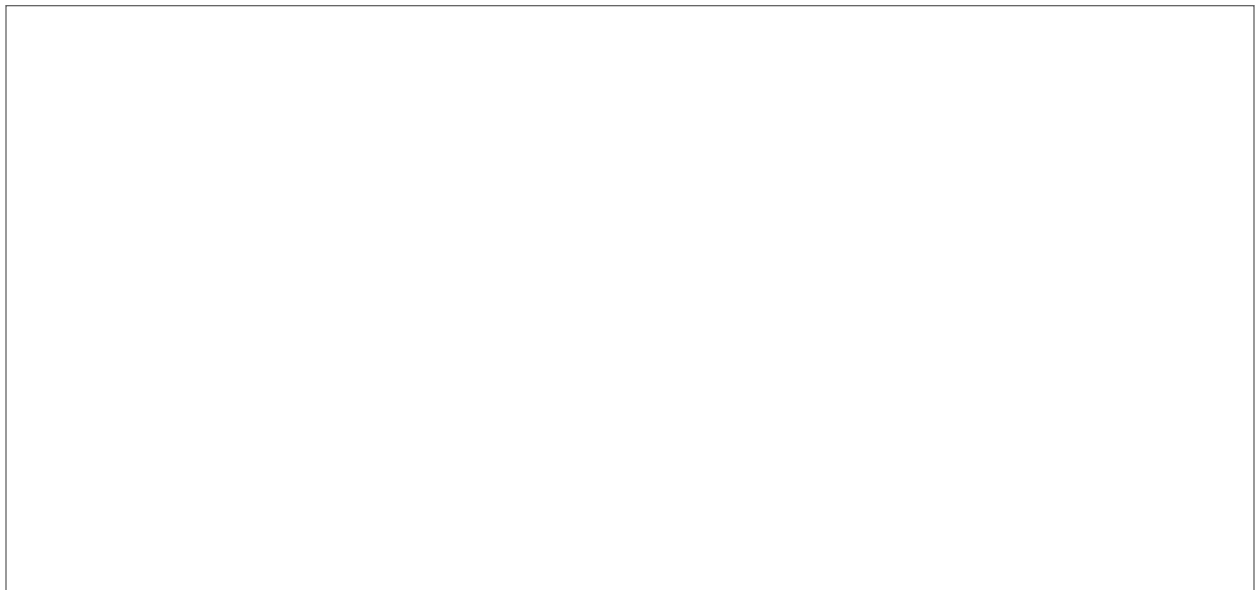
Date: _____ Location: _____

Weather: _____ Temperature: _____ Season: _____

Time spent outdoors: _____ Companions: _____

WHAT I OBSERVED TODAY:

SKETCH AREA (draw what you observed):



Species/Object identified: _____

Questions I want to research: _____

Connection to previous observations: _____

NATURE STUDY JOURNAL - Entry 6

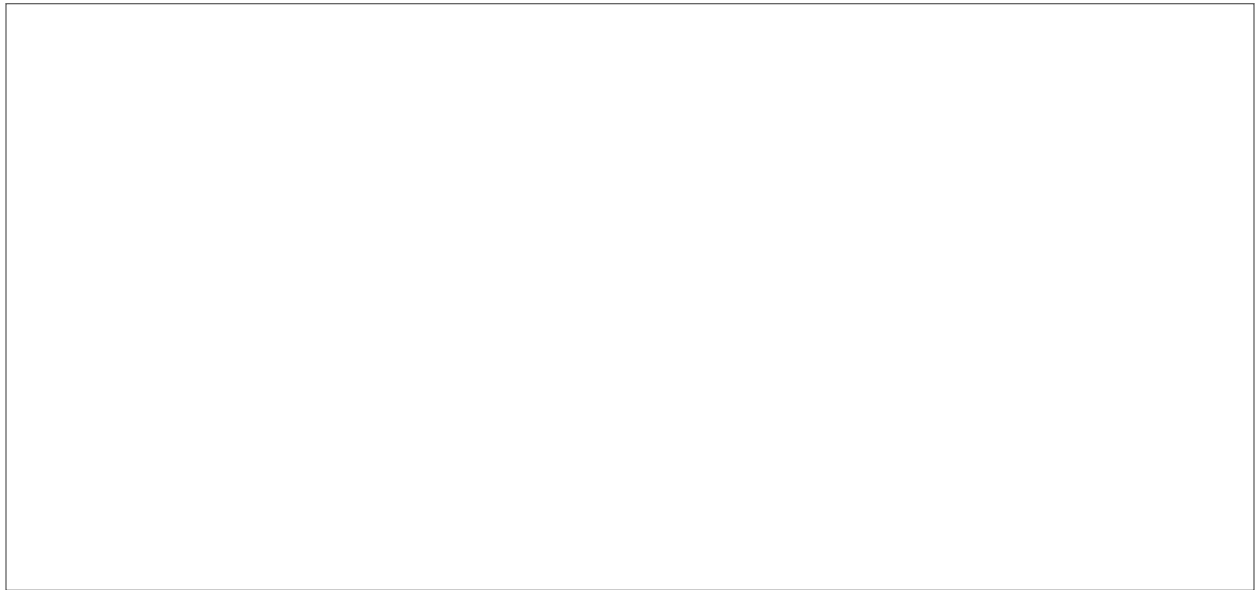
Date: _____ Location: _____

Weather: _____ Temperature: _____ Season: _____

Time spent outdoors: _____ Companions: _____

WHAT I OBSERVED TODAY:

SKETCH AREA (draw what you observed):



Species/Object identified: _____

Questions I want to research: _____

Connection to previous observations: _____

NATURE STUDY JOURNAL - Entry 7

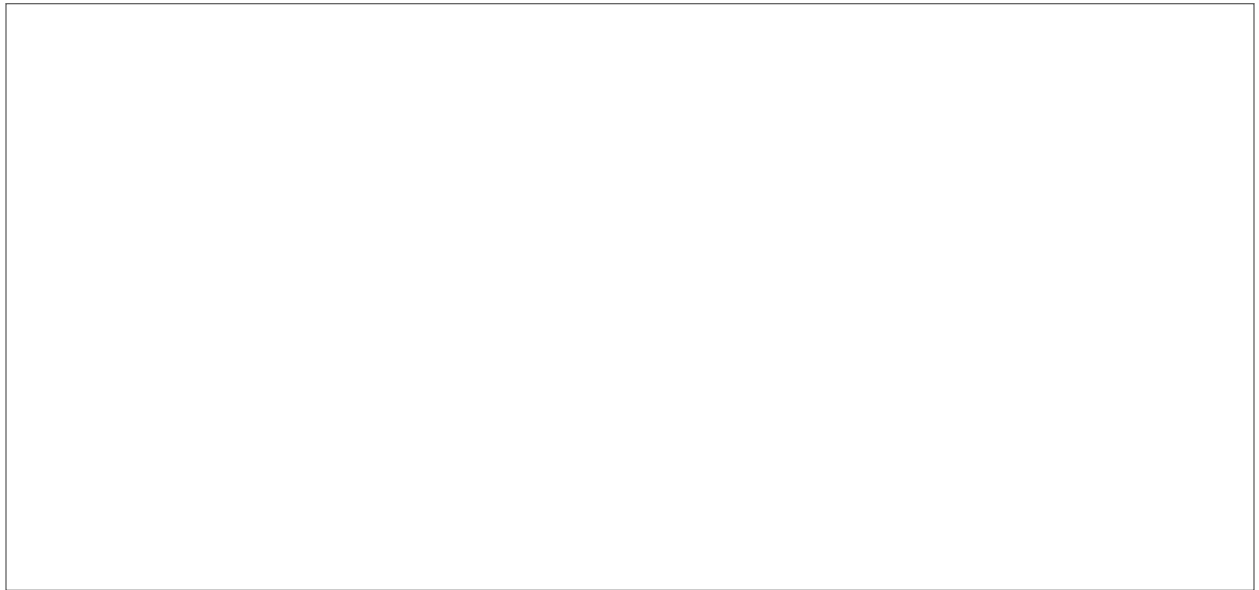
Date: _____ Location: _____

Weather: _____ Temperature: _____ Season: _____

Time spent outdoors: _____ Companions: _____

WHAT I OBSERVED TODAY:

SKETCH AREA (draw what you observed):



Species/Object identified: _____

Questions I want to research: _____

Connection to previous observations: _____

NATURE STUDY JOURNAL - Entry 8

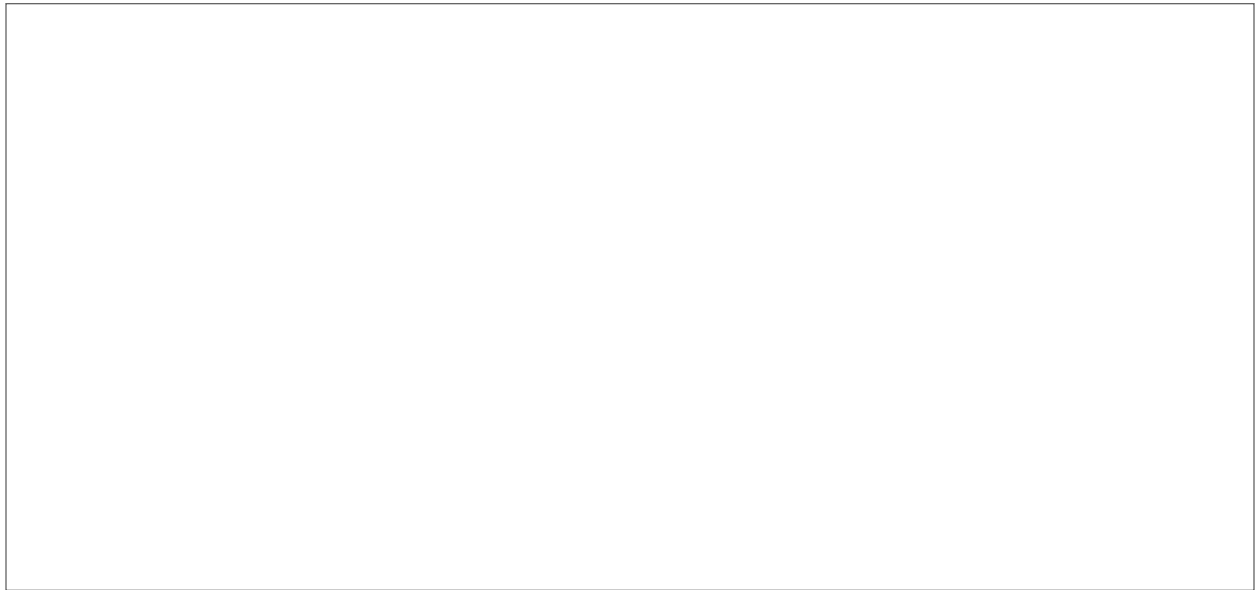
Date: _____ Location: _____

Weather: _____ Temperature: _____ Season: _____

Time spent outdoors: _____ Companions: _____

WHAT I OBSERVED TODAY:

SKETCH AREA (draw what you observed):



Species/Object identified: _____

Questions I want to research: _____

Connection to previous observations: _____

[illegible]

NARRATION RECORD - Page 1

Date: _____ Book Title: _____

Pages/Chapter: _____ Child: _____

CHILD'S NARRATION (in their own words):

Vocabulary/ideas child used well: _____

Areas to develop: _____

Date: _____ Book Title: _____

Pages/Chapter: _____ Child: _____

CHILD'S NARRATION (in their own words):

Vocabulary/ideas child used well: _____

Areas to develop: _____

NARRATION RECORD - Page 2

Date: _____ Book Title: _____

Pages/Chapter: _____ Child: _____

CHILD'S NARRATION (in their own words):

Vocabulary/ideas child used well: _____

Areas to develop: _____

Date: _____ Book Title: _____

Pages/Chapter: _____ Child: _____

CHILD'S NARRATION (in their own words):

Vocabulary/ideas child used well: _____

Areas to develop: _____

NARRATION RECORD - Page 3

Date: _____ Book Title: _____

Pages/Chapter: _____ Child: _____

CHILD'S NARRATION (in their own words):

Vocabulary/ideas child used well: _____

Areas to develop: _____

Date: _____ Book Title: _____

Pages/Chapter: _____ Child: _____

CHILD'S NARRATION (in their own words):

Vocabulary/ideas child used well: _____

Areas to develop: _____

NARRATION RECORD - Page 4

Date: _____ Book Title: _____

Pages/Chapter: _____ Child: _____

CHILD'S NARRATION (in their own words):

Vocabulary/ideas child used well: _____

Areas to develop: _____

Date: _____ Book Title: _____

Pages/Chapter: _____ Child: _____

CHILD'S NARRATION (in their own words):

Vocabulary/ideas child used well: _____

Areas to develop: _____

NARRATION RECORD - Page 5

Date: _____ Book Title: _____

Pages/Chapter: _____ Child: _____

CHILD'S NARRATION (in their own words):

Vocabulary/ideas child used well: _____

Areas to develop: _____

Date: _____ Book Title: _____

Pages/Chapter: _____ Child: _____

CHILD'S NARRATION (in their own words):

Vocabulary/ideas child used well: _____

Areas to develop: _____

HABIT TRAINING TRACKER - Page 1

January:

Habit focus: _____

Week 1: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 2: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Week 3: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 4: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Established? ☐ Yes ☐ No Notes: _____

February:

Habit focus: _____

Week 1: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 2: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Week 3: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 4: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Established? ☐ Yes ☐ No Notes: _____

March:

Habit focus: _____

Week 1: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 2: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Week 3: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 4: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Established? ☐ Yes ☐ No Notes: _____

April:

Habit focus: _____

Week 1: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 2: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Week 3: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 4: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Established? ☐ Yes ☐ No Notes: _____

May:

Habit focus: _____

Week 1: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 2: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Week 3: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 4: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Established? ☐ Yes ☐ No Notes: _____

June:

Habit focus: _____

Week 1: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 2: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Week 3: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 4: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Established? ☐ Yes ☐ No Notes: _____

HABIT TRAINING TRACKER - Page 2

July:

Habit focus: _____

Week 1: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 2: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Week 3: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 4: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Established? ☐ Yes ☐ No Notes: _____

August:

Habit focus: _____

Week 1: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 2: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Week 3: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 4: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Established? ☐ Yes ☐ No Notes: _____

September:

Habit focus: _____

Week 1: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 2: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Week 3: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 4: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Established? ☐ Yes ☐ No Notes: _____

October:

Habit focus: _____

Week 1: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 2: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Week 3: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 4: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Established? ☐ Yes ☐ No Notes: _____

November:

Habit focus: _____

Week 1: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 2: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Week 3: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 4: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Established? ☐ Yes ☐ No Notes: _____

December:

Habit focus: _____

Week 1: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 2: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Week 3: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] Week 4: [] [] [] [] [] [] []

Established? ☐ Yes ☐ No Notes: _____

COMPOSER & ARTIST STUDY LOG

COMPOSER STUDY (listen to one composer per term):

Term 1 Composer: _____ Era: _____

Pieces listened to: _____

Child's response: _____

Term 2 Composer: _____ Era: _____

Pieces listened to: _____

Child's response: _____

Term 3 Composer: _____ Era: _____

Pieces listened to: _____

Child's response: _____

ARTIST/PICTURE STUDY (study one artist per term):

Term 1 Artist: _____ Style: _____

Works studied: _____

Child's observations: _____

Term 2 Artist: _____ Style: _____

Works studied: _____

Child's observations: _____

Term 3 Artist: _____ Style: _____

Works studied: _____

Child's observations: _____

HANDICRAFT PROGRESS LOG

Charlotte Mason valued working with hands. Track handicraft skills:

Craft/Skill	Started	Current Level	Next Goal
Knitting			
Sewing/Embroidery			
Woodworking			
Weaving			
Pottery/Clay			
Cooking/Baking			
Gardening			
Calligraphy			
Origami/Paper			
Drawing/Painting			
Crochet			
Other:			

Current project:

Materials needed:

POETRY & SHAKESPEARE LOG

POETRY MEMORIZATION:

Poem Title	Poet	Memorized?	Recited?
_____	_____	☐	☐
_____	_____	☐	☐
_____	_____	☐	☐
_____	_____	☐	☐
_____	_____	☐	☐
_____	_____	☐	☐
_____	_____	☐	☐
_____	_____	☐	☐
_____	_____	☐	☐
_____	_____	☐	☐

SHAKESPEARE (one play per term):

Term 1: Play: _____ Completed: []

Method (read aloud / acted / Lamb's Tales): _____

Child's favorite part: _____

Term 2: Play: _____ Completed: []

Method (read aloud / acted / Lamb's Tales): _____

Child's favorite part: _____

Term 3: Play: _____ Completed: []

Method (read aloud / acted / Lamb's Tales): _____

Child's favorite part: _____

PICTURE STUDY - Session 1

Artist: _____ Title: _____

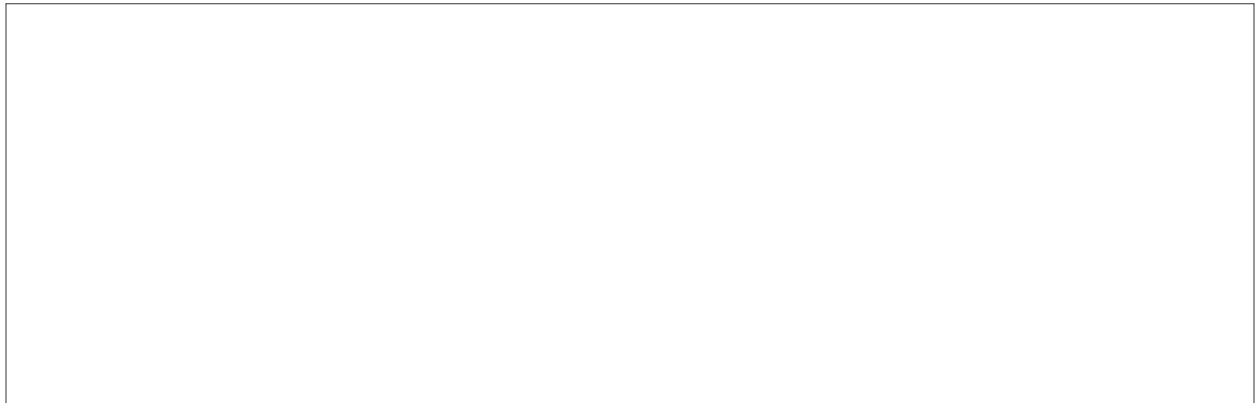
Date: _____ Medium: _____ Year: _____

FIRST IMPRESSION (what do you notice first?):

DETAILS (look closely - colors, light, expressions, objects):

TELL THE STORY (what do you think is happening?):

SKETCH FROM MEMORY (close the picture, draw what you remember):



PICTURE STUDY - Session 2

Artist: _____ Title: _____

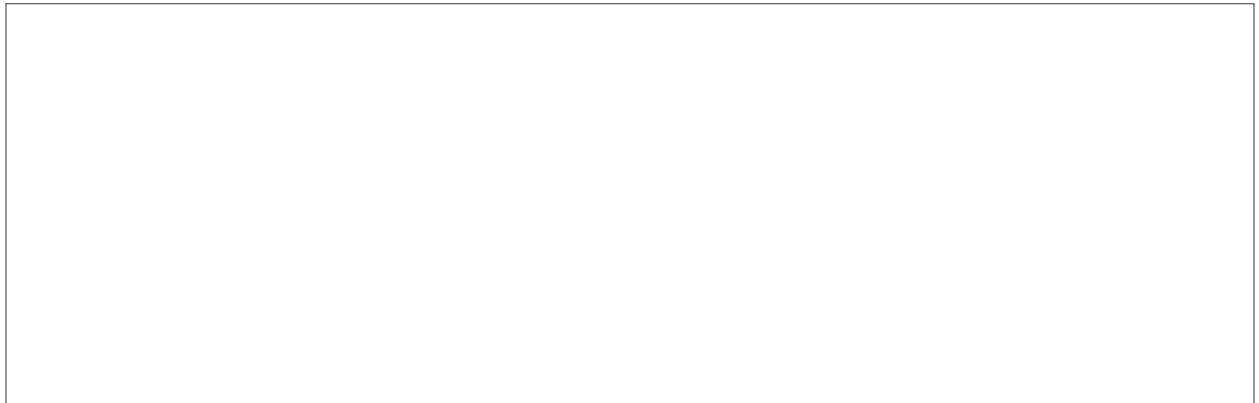
Date: _____ Medium: _____ Year: _____

FIRST IMPRESSION (what do you notice first?):

DETAILS (look closely - colors, light, expressions, objects):

TELL THE STORY (what do you think is happening?):

SKETCH FROM MEMORY (close the picture, draw what you remember):



PICTURE STUDY - Session 3

Artist: _____ Title: _____

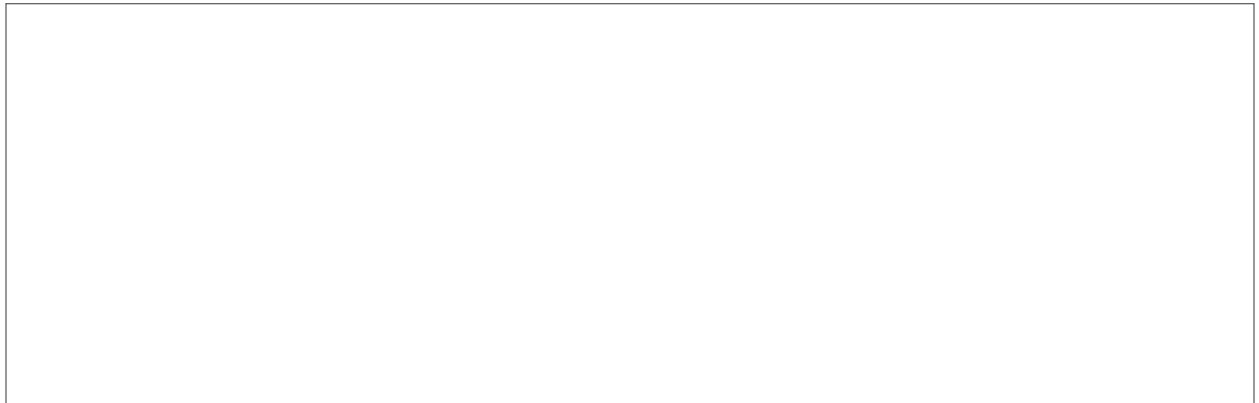
Date: _____ Medium: _____ Year: _____

FIRST IMPRESSION (what do you notice first?):

DETAILS (look closely - colors, light, expressions, objects):

TELL THE STORY (what do you think is happening?):

SKETCH FROM MEMORY (close the picture, draw what you remember):



FOREIGN LANGUAGE PROGRESS

Language: _____ Method: _____

Resource/Curriculum: _____

VOCABULARY LEARNED THIS TERM:

Word/Phrase:	_____	Meaning:	_____
Word/Phrase:	_____	Meaning:	_____
Word/Phrase:	_____	Meaning:	_____
Word/Phrase:	_____	Meaning:	_____
Word/Phrase:	_____	Meaning:	_____
Word/Phrase:	_____	Meaning:	_____
Word/Phrase:	_____	Meaning:	_____
Word/Phrase:	_____	Meaning:	_____
Word/Phrase:	_____	Meaning:	_____
Word/Phrase:	_____	Meaning:	_____
Word/Phrase:	_____	Meaning:	_____
Word/Phrase:	_____	Meaning:	_____

Songs/poems in target language:

Conversational phrases mastered:

[illegible]

Family memory verse this month: _____

YEAR-END EVALUATION

Greatest academic growth this year:

Character growth observed:

Favorite books we read:

Most successful subject/approach:

What didn't work well (change next year):

Nature study highlights:

Habits established:

Goals for next year:

My child's reflections on the year:
